

# Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

## Nonsense!

Computer-generated gibberish masquerading as an academic paper has been accepted at a scientific conference.

Jeremy Stribling, one of the three brains behind this plot, said that he and two fellow MIT graduate students questioned the standards of some academic conferences, so they wrote a computer program to generate research papers complete with charts and diagrams. The trio submitted two of the randomly assembled papers to the World Multi-Conference on Systemics, Cybernetics and Informatics (WMSCI), scheduled to be held July 10-13 later this year in Orlando, Florida.

To their surprise, one of the papers—"Rooter: A Methodology for the Typical Unification of Access Points and Redundancy"—was accepted for presentation.

The paper features such gems as: "The model for our heuristic consists of four independent components: simulated annealing, active networks, flexible modalities, and the study of reinforcement learning" and "... scatter/gather I/O server in Simula-67, augmented with opportunistically pipelined extensions."

Nagib Callaos, a conference organiser, said that they were now reviewing their acceptance procedures.

## Now, Robot Sex Dolls

This is exciting news from the robotics department: German inventor Michael Harriman claims to have created the world's most sophisticated robot sex doll.

Harriman said, "They are almost impossible to distinguish from the real thing, but ... I will only be happy when what I have is *better* than the real thing." Now *that's* dedication! Hats off to German engineering!

The dolls are on offer for £4,000 (Rs 3.3 lakh), with extra

charges for adaptations like extra-large breasts. Now *that's* pricing!

The model can also be made to move by remote control, wiggling her hips under the bedclothes and making other suggestive movements—all at the click of a button.

The more libidinous amongst us are apt to say that technology has finally arrived. And £4,000 is a small price to pay for something that's better than the real thing... who says innovation is dead?

## Hackers Stole My Sex Video!

A lawsuit filed on behalf of Limp Bizkit lead singer Fred Durst alleges that the same people who hacked Paris Hilton's cell phone were able to pull a homemade sex video off Durst's computer.

*The Smoking Gun*, a tabloid news Web site, has obtained part of Durst's complaint against various Web sites that posted portions of Durst's sex romp with a former girlfriend.

The document states that the US Secret Service has kicked off an "elaborate investigation"

into Durst's home movie mess. The singer is seeking up to \$80m, or Rs 348 crore (a little too much?) for having his privates put on the Web without consent, according to *The Smoking Gun*.

Durst's lawsuit alleges that Web site operators contacted him to ask about making a deal to sell his homemade sex video online. The lawsuit goes on to say



Gimme back my video: Fred Durst

that Durst declined to make such a deal, believing he had the lone copy of the video. "The only copy of the Video was on the hard drive of the Plaintiff's computer, and was subsequently stolen therefrom," says the lawsuit.

At the time of going to print, Durst was still trying to have the video and the still photos made from it removed from the Web.

## Prince Harry Flunks Computer Test

Britain's Prince Harry has been in the news for several reasons, good and bad, and the latest on

the list is, we assume, bad: he shocked army instructors by failing a basic computer competence test. The test, at Royal Military Academy Sandhurst, England, was part of a familiarisation course before he starts as a trainee officer there.

A source quoted by the *Daily Mirror* said, "Although the test was considerably more complex than just

sending e-mails, instructors were amazed that Harry failed it." Harry, it seems, was worse at computers than other new recruits.

Harry presumably has plenty of offline diversions that keep him from getting online too much.



"Binary... Duh!"

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